EUR ING Andrew Knott

MBA (Leeds - Distinction) | Dipl Eng | BSc (Hons) | CEng | FIET | FinstMC | CMgr | FCMI | FAPM | PMP®
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Professional Summary

Project/Programme Manager/Director - Industry 4.0
An award-winning Principal Consultant combining 30 years of deep technical expertise in Industry 4.0 automation (OT) with recent high-level business strategy qualifications (MBA with Distinction, 2025). A Fellow of the IET, CMI, and APM, offering a rare blend of engineering authority and commercial acumen. Proven track record of delivering multi-million-pound capital projects for global life science leaders (Novo Nordisk, GE Healthcare, Takeda). Uniquely qualified to bridge the gap between technical engineering teams and board-level strategic objectives. Available for short-term and project-based engagements — from GAMP 5 compliance and CSV strategy through to MES implementation, programme recovery, and hands-on automation delivery. Senior-level expertise without the consultancy overheads.

Core Competencies

Strategic Leadership: Digital Transformation, Smart Factory Strategy, Stakeholder Management, Budget Oversight.
* Automation & IT: MES (Werum PAS-X, OpCenter), DCS (DeltaV, Siemens PCS7), PLC (Siemens, Rockwell), SCADA/Historian (AVEVA InTouch, PI, Ignition), Industrial AI, ISA S88, S95, Cyber Security (ISA/IEC 62443).
* Technical Governance: GAMP 5, CSV & Data Integrity, Quality Management Systems (QMS), 21 CFR Part 11.
* Project Management: PMP® Certified, PMI-ACP Agile/Scrum, Vendor Management, Risk Mitigation.

Professional Experience

Project/Programme Director & Strategic Consultant | Knott Advisory / Automation Projects | Global **Jan 2012-present**

Operated as lead consultant delivering high-value engagements for Tier-1 Pharma clients. Now seeking to transfer this expertise into a permanent corporate leadership role.

Directing large-scale automation, MES, and digital compliance programmes. Responsible for strategy definition, budget oversight, and the technical leadership of cross-functional teams across the UK and Europe.
Commercial Leadership: Successfully secured Approved Supplier Status with Johnson & Johnson (Janssen), Takeda, and PALL Life Sciences, validating high standards of corporate governance and technical delivery

Recent Major Projects/Programmes (2016 – Present)

- **GE Healthcare (2024) - Programme Director:** Led the Basic Design phase for a major MES/eBR (PAS-X) and Historian (AVEVA PI) deployment, aligning technical architecture with global business requirements.
- **SolutionsPT (2023) - SME:** -- Product Validation and Octoplant deployment, ensuring robust configuration management across critical OT infrastructure.
- **Novo Nordisk (Jacobs) (2022)** - **CSV Project Manager:** - Defined the Global CSV Strategy for new-build capital projects, standardising validation approaches to reduce time-to-market for critical assets.
- **Cognizant (2021) - Associate Director:** - for Life Sciences MES projects, managing delivery timelines and stakeholder expectations at an executive level.
- **Takeda, Germany (2020) - Programme Manager:** -- Managed a complex Level 2/3 Automation Upgrade (150 systems) across 5 workstreams. Delivered the project from Concept to Execution, utilising Siemens S7-1500 and Virtualised Architectures.
- **Janssen (JnJ), Belgium (2016 – 2019) - Project Lead:** - Automation & CSV workstream for a multi-purpose API facility (DeltaV 11,000 IO). Built and supervised the engineering team from Basic Design through to Handover. Integrated site-wide virtualised architecture with Level 3 systems (OSIsoft PI / Werum PAS-X).

- **Interim Project Leadership Roles (2012 – 2016)**
- **Dr. Reddy's (2015–16) - Principal SME:**. Led gap analysis and remediation planning for a Siemens PCS 7 batch control system at a Bulk API facility.
- **Bio Products Laboratory (2015) - Site Automation SME:** Directed validation for aseptic filling lines, washers, and fractionation control system upgrades.
- **Dynavax (Rhein Biotech), Germany (2014–15) - Interim Automation Manager**: Developed site strategy, managed system inventory, and led automation CAPA remediation.
- **Schneider Electric (Eurotherm) (2014) - Senior Project Manager:** for nuclear and chemical projects involving Wonderware systems.
- **Fluor Ltd (2013–14) Project Manager (E, I & A).** Directed conception to handover for High Voltage (11kV) and Rockwell automation systems for a Carbon Fibre manufacturer (Hexcel).
- **MSD (Animal Health) (2013) - Principal Consultant:** Developed site automation strategy, risk analysis, and inventory for 150 systems across three sites.

- **NNE / UCB, Switzerland (2012–13) - Senior Specialist & Project Manager:** Led the implementation of DeltaV and Syncade MES for a new biotech plant.
- **Gedeon Richter, Hungary (2012):Automation Project Manager:** Led ABB 800xA DCS implementation for a Biosimilar facility.

Previous Career History

Principal Automation Consultant | PM Group | Global 2008 – 2012

* Business Leadership: Established and led the Automation & Information Systems (AIS) business unit, recruiting a core team of 10 engineers.
* Vendor Partnerships: Attained Solution Partner certification with Siemens Automation and ABB Automation.
* Client Status: Approved preferred supplier to GSK, Sanofi, and Weyerhaeuser.
* Strategic Standards: Developed global automation standards (ISA-95 Levels 1-3) to drive consistency across international capital projects.
* Quality Systems: Developed ISO 9001/TickIT Quality Management System and gained certification within 5 months.

Business Unit Director (Process Automation) | Fluor Ltd | UK & Europe 1999 – 2008

* Team Growth: Formed and grew the Process Automation Group (PAG) to 25 engineers, achieving ISO 9001/TickIT certification within 5 months.
*Vendor Ecosystem: Secured Solution Partner certification with Siemens, Rockwell Automation, Wonderware, and ABB.
* Client Status: Established the unit as an approved preferred supplier to GSK, Sanofi, Wyeth, and Novo Nordisk.
* Project Director (GSK): Led the Biopharma Process Development Control & SCADA project at Stevenage & Beckenham.
* Automation Manager (Novo Nordisk): Managed the automation team for an Insulin Bulk Plant in Denmark ABB SattLine.

Senior Engineer / Principal Engineer/ Technical Consultant | John Brown Engineers | Portsmouth 1992 – 1998

* Lead Engineer for major automation systems at GlaxoWellcome (Biology Plant) and Zeneca (Quorn II).

Technical Project Manager | Siemens UK & Germany 1978 – 1991

*Progressed from Technician Apprentice to Technical Project Manager. Sponsored through university and promoted annually.

Education

Master of Business Administration (MBA) – Distinction | University of Leeds (2025)
*Award: Dean's Prize for Top Student (Best Overall Performance in Cohort > 75%).
*Live Challenges (Capstone): Achieved Top Cohort Mark (85% Distinction).
*New ESG Product Innovation: Developed strategic framework for sustainable product lifecycle.
*Consultancy Project: Go-to-Market Strategy for In-house Software Products (Digital Publishing).
* Key Modules: Strategic HRM (86%), Global Marketing (88%), Leading in Practice (78%), Procurement and Supply Chain (89%).

Executive Education (MBA Modules) | Warwick Business School (2024)
* Distinctions in Operations Management (72%), Strategic Advantage (72%) and Digital Transformation (71%).

Dipl Eng (Process Automation) – Engineers Degree – 5 Year Programme | University of Salford (1993)

BSc (Hons) Electronic & Electrical Engineering (1st Class) | University of Salford (1986)

Artificial Intelligence – Professional Certificate | University of Oxford (Saïd Business School) (2021)

Exceptional Non-Executive Director (NED) Programme with placement – Leeds University Business School – Feb 2026

Level 3 Award in Teaching & Education – TQUK – Feb 2026 (Ongoing until May 2026)

Professional Qualifications

European Engineer (EUR ING) & Chartered Engineer (CEng)
Fellow, Institution of Engineering & Technology (FIET)
Fellow, Institute of Measurement & Control (FInstMC)
Chartered Manager (CMgr)
Fellow, Chartered Management Institute (FCMI)
Fellow, Association for Project Management (FAPM)
PMP® (Project Management Professional) & PMI-ACP® (Agile Certified Practitioner)

Volunteering

Mentor & Assessor: Active volunteer for the IET and CMI, mentoring engineers and managers toward Charterted Engineer (CEng) and serving as an assessor for the Chartered Manager (CMgr) award.